P23
AFRICA



FUNDING DIRECTORY

FUNDING OPPORTUNITIES FOR AFRICAN BUSINESSES



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Finding the right funding shouldn't feel impossible. This directory gives you direct access to grants, investors, and accelerators that are actively supporting African startups — including pre-revenue and early-stage businesses. Whether you're building your first MVP or scaling across borders, you'll discover verified funding opportunities in over 120 African countries and beyond — all in one place.

HOW TO USE THE DIRECTORY

This directory is your roadmap to finding the right funding partner for your business. It's designed to help you navigate opportunities quickly and apply with clarity.

1. Know Your Stage
Before you begin, identify your business stage:

- Idea Stage: You're validating your concept or building an MVP.
- Early-Stage: You've launched and are gaining initial traction.
- Growth Stage: You're scaling and expanding into new markets.

Each listing includes the stage it supports — start where you are, not where you hope to be.

2. Choose the Right Funding Type
The directory includes:

- 💡 Grants – Non-repayable funds for early innovation or impact.
- 💰 Investors & VCs – Equity-based funding for startups ready to scale.
- 🚀 Accelerators & Incubators – Programs offering funding, mentorship, and visibility.

3. Filter by Geography
Some programs are Pan-African, while others are country-specific.
Start by reviewing opportunities in your home market or region, then explore international investors who actively support African founders.

4. Prepare Before You Apply
Having the right materials makes all the difference.
Ensure you have:

- A clear 1-page business summary or pitch deck
- Defined problem, solution, and market opportunity
- A simple budget or funding breakdown
- A clear impact or growth story

5. Apply Intentionally
Don't apply to everything — apply to what fits.
Shortlist 5–10 relevant opportunities, personalize your applications, and track your submissions.
Use a simple spreadsheet or tracker to record:

- Program name
- Deadline
- Status
- Response

Section A: International Grants

Mastercard Foundation

- **What they fund:** Financial inclusion, youth employment, digital skills and entrepreneurship programmes across Africa.
- **Who qualifies:** NGOs, social enterprises, and businesses with strong social impact models.
- **Application process: Often via calls for proposals or through partner organisations/accelerators; send a capability statement to local partner channels.**

Insider Tips (from grant reviewers & past awardees)

💡 **1. Align with youth employment targets: Many of their programmes (e.g., Young Africa Works) prioritise interventions that create decent work for young people – so your proposal should clearly show how your business or programme will contribute to youth employment.**
💡 **2. Show measurable outcomes: Funders want to see that your project can demonstrate clear results (jobs created, people trained, technology adopted) and not just deliver outputs.**
💡 **3. Build a sustainability/scale-up pathway: Beyond the grant or funding period, how will your model continue? How will it scale or sustain itself financially?**
💡 **4. Use local networks or partners: Many calls are via partner organisations, accelerators or country-based channels – being connected locally boosts credibility.**
💡 **5. Start preparation early: Even if you don't see the 2026 call yet, use the time to refine your value proposition, metrics, and impact story.**

European Union / EU Grants (Horizon Europe, EU Development & NDICI)

- **What they fund:** Research, innovation, trade, and development projects (often multi-partner consortia across countries).
- **Who qualifies:** SMEs, sometimes in partnership with research institutions and NGOs.
- **Application process: Competitive calls published on EU portals → full proposal (technical + budget) → evaluation.**

Insider Tips (from EU grant reviewers & past awardees)

💡 1. Partner early with an EU-based lead.
Having a strong EU partner (university, research institute, or implementing agency) signals capacity, compliance, and legitimacy.
💡 2. Show clear international collaboration value.
EU funding prioritizes cross-border impact — demonstrate how your African organisation adds unique local insight or implementation strength to the consortium.
💡 3. Keep your budget audit-ready.
EU evaluators are strict on financial compliance — ensure your budget follows official cost categories (direct, indirect, travel, staff) and is justified line by line.
💡 4. Prove sustainability beyond the project.
Show how project results will continue post-funding, e.g, through commercial adoption, public sector partnerships, or follow-on investment.
💡 5. Emphasize knowledge sharing and dissemination.
Include clear plans for publishing results, stakeholder engagement, and how findings will contribute to global or regional policy conversations.
💡 6. Don't overcomplicate your proposal.
Reviewers prefer concise, evidence-backed proposals over jargon-filled text. Focus on outcomes, impact pathways, and measurable innovation.

African Development Bank: Africa Climate Finance

- **What they fund:** Climate adaptation, renewable energy, agribusiness, and infrastructure enablers; technical assistance for SMEs.
- **Who qualifies:** Registered businesses, SMEs, and project sponsors in member countries.
- **Application process: Expression of interest → feasibility / technical assistance → project approval; often channelled via national implementing agencies.**

Insider Tips (from AfDB evaluators & successful applicants)

💡 1. Lead with measurable climate impact.
Quantify your climate co-benefits — e.g., CO_2 reduction, energy savings, hectares restored, or farmers reached. Use clear metrics and baseline data.
💡 2. Show financial viability and scalability.
The AfDB looks for projects that can attract blended finance, grants, concessional loans, and private capital. Demonstrate a pathway to profitability or replication.
💡 3. Align with national climate priorities.
Reference your country's Nationally Determined Contributions (NDCs) or Climate Action Plans to show alignment with government strategy.
💡 4. Build partnerships with public agencies.
Collaborate with ministries of environment, energy, or agriculture, these partnerships can accelerate approval and funding access.
💡 5. Prepare strong documentation early.
Develop a solid feasibility study, financial model, and environmental & social impact assessment (ESIA), these are required for project appraisal.
💡 6. Be ready for due diligence.
AfDB projects undergo strict review, ensure your business has transparent governance, financial records, and compliance systems in place.

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UNDP Small Grants Programme / UN Women / FAO grants

- **What they fund:** Community-level projects, women-led businesses, agri value-chain improvements and sustainability.
- **Who qualifies:** Small enterprises, cooperatives, CSOs with strong community reach.
- **Application process: National calls via UNDP country office; local NGO partnership is often required.**

Insider Tips (from UN programme officers & past grantees)

💡 1. Engage early with local UN offices.
Reach out to your UNDP, FAO, or UN Women country office before submitting — early conversations help align your proposal with national programme priorities.
💡 2. Show community validation and support.
Include letters of endorsement, MOUs, or testimonies from local leaders or beneficiaries to demonstrate legitimacy and impact ownership.
💡 3. Emphasize inclusion and gender equity.
Highlight how your project benefits women, youth, and marginalized groups, and how it integrates these voices in decision-making.
💡 4. Focus on measurable, replicable results.
Use clear indicators like increased incomes, improved food security, or reduced environmental degradation — and explain how success can be replicated in other communities.
💡 5. Leverage partnerships for strength.
Collaborating with local NGOs, universities, or private sector partners increases your project's technical and sustainability credibility.
💡 6. Keep proposals simple and evidence-driven.
Avoid heavy jargon — use data, community insights, and visual impact stories that clearly show how your idea solves a real, local problem.

GSMA Innovation Fund (Mobile for Development)

- **What they fund:** Mobile-based services with social impact (finance, health, agriculture).
- **Who qualifies:** Tech SMEs and startups using mobile or telco partnerships.
- **Application process: Open calls announced on GSMA website; proof of concept favoured.**

Insider Tips (from foundation reviewers & past grantees)

💡 **1. Build credibility through partnerships.**
Collaborate with local NGOs, research institutions, or established grantee networks to strengthen your proposal and demonstrate implementation capacity.
💡 **2. Secure trusted referrals.**
Connections or endorsements from existing grantee partners or well-known development actors can significantly improve your visibility with foundation reviewers.
💡 **3. Show systems-change impact.**
Foundations look for projects that go beyond pilot interventions, demonstrating measurable impact on communities, markets, or policy frameworks.
💡 **4. Include rigorous monitoring and evaluation.**
Present clear metrics, targets, and evaluation plans to demonstrate how outcomes will be tracked, analyzed, and scaled.
💡 **5. Align with strategic priorities.**
Carefully review each foundation's current strategy and align your proposal with their focus areas and thematic priorities.
💡 **6. Prepare for long timelines.**
Foundation grants often involve lengthy review cycles, so submit proposals early and maintain ongoing engagement with program officers when possible.

Climate-Focused Grants (Climate Justice Resilience Fund, Green Climate Fund)

- **What they fund:** Green tech, climate adaptation, sustainable agriculture.
- **Who qualifies:** SMEs and projects with clear climate benefits and measurable outcomes.
- **Application process: Often via national designated authorities or accredited agencies.**

Insider Tips (from fund reviewers & past awardees)

💡 **1. Emphasize MRV (Measurement, Reporting, Verification).**
Clearly outline how your project's climate impact will be measured, monitored, and verified.
💡 **2. Demonstrate scalability.**
Show how the project can expand beyond the initial pilot phase to reach more communities or regions sustainably.
💡 **3. Build robust cost-benefit projections.**
Include detailed financial and economic models showing how climate benefits are achieved relative to project costs.
💡 **4. Align with national climate priorities.**
Reference your country's Nationally Determined Contributions (NDCs) or climate strategies to demonstrate relevance and alignment.
💡 **5. Leverage accredited partners.**
Collaborate with recognized NDAs, NGOs, or accredited agencies to strengthen credibility and compliance with fund requirements.
💡 **6. Keep proposals concise and evidence-based.**
Fund reviewers prefer clear, data-backed proposals that focus on impact, feasibility, and sustainability over long narratives.

Tony Elumelu Entrepreneurship Programme (TEEP)

- **What they fund:** Seed capital and business development support to African entrepreneurs (pan-Africa).
- **Who qualifies:** Early-stage African entrepreneurs for a fixed cohort program.

Application process: Cohort applications → selection → training → seed capital disbursement.

Insider Tips (from TEEP reviewers & past cohorts)

💡 **1. Present a feasible business model.**
Clearly demonstrate how your business works, including revenue streams, target market, and operational plan.
💡 **2. Highlight job creation potential.**
TEEP prioritizes businesses that can create employment — quantify potential hires and impact.
💡 **3. Show scalability.**
Explain how your business can grow across regions or markets sustainably.
💡 **4. Keep applications concise and focused.**
The selection panel favors clear, well-structured applications that quickly convey value and impact.
💡 **5. Engage with mentors early.**
Participating in training and networking helps refine your proposal and increases your likelihood of success.
💡 **6. Use evidence and data.**
Support claims with market research, pilot results, or financial projections to strengthen credibility.

Embassies & Trade Promotion Grants (UK FCDO, Germany GIZ, Canadian CIDA)

- **What they fund:** Market entry, trade facilitation, private sector development programmes.
- **Who qualifies:** SMEs with export potential or job creation benefits.
- **Application process: Through bilateral development organisations or embassy trade desks.**

Insider Tips (from embassy trade officers & past grantees)

💡 **1. Engage trade desks early.**
Start conversations with the embassy or trade office to get guidance, refine your proposal, and ensure alignment with national priorities.
💡 **2. Highlight export potential and partnerships.**
Demonstrate how your business can reach new markets, and show existing or potential local partnerships that will enable market entry.
💡 **3. Leverage embassy introductions.**
Use connections to buyers, distributors, or local partners as part of your proposal, this strengthens credibility and practical feasibility.
💡 **4. Emphasize job creation and impact.**
Projects that clearly create employment or improve SME competitiveness are favored.
💡 **5. Prepare strong documentation.**
Have a clear business plan, budget, and trade strategy ready — this accelerates review and approval.
💡 **6. Be concise and practical.**
Officers value proposals that are direct, realistic, and outcome-focused over lengthy narratives.

Application Checklist

1. **Start with a 1-page concept note:**
State a clear problem, outline your solution in simple terms, outline your plan to scale, and include a budget summary. Don't send 20 pages of information they don't need.

2. **Show traction & KPIs:**
Even pilot numbers (revenue, users, retention) make you credible. Grants favour measurable impact.

3. **Local partnerships matter:**
Showing evidence and impact of working with local NGOs, universities, or private partners increase your chances of success.

4. **Budget realistically:**
Include co-financing (from your pocket or external contributions) and in-kind contributions (volunteers, etc) where possible; show unit costs and sustainability beyond what the grant will give you.

Application Checklist

5. **Prepare for due diligence:**
Provide company documents, leadership bios, bank statements, and sample contracts early.

6.Tailor language to funder goals:
Use the funder's own frameworks (e.g. SDGs, gender lens, climate metrics) in your application.

7.Use stories and data:
A short beneficiary story showing impact numbers work better than many pages of theory.

8.Ask for feedback:
If rejected, request the reviewers' feedback, iterate and apply again. Many winners succeed on round 2 or 3.

Section B: African Funders & VCs

These are prominent, active funds, investors and grant partners relevant to startups and scale-ups in different African countries. Make sure to vet each fund before contact.

Nigeria

VC/ FUNDER	STAGE	FOCUS	AREA	TIPS
TLcom Capital	Seed → Growth	Fintech, marketplaces, tech-enabled services	Pan-African invests allover Africa	Highlight scalability and traction; emphasize Pan-African expansion potential
EchoVC Partners	Early-stage	Tech startups, Nigeria + Africa	Select African deals; mostly Nigeria & West Africa	Show strong product-market fit and early adoption metrics
Ventures Platform	Seed → Early	Tech startups; accelerator programs	Mostly Nigeria-focused, some West Africa	Participate in accelerator to increase visibility; show problem-solution fit and traction

VC/ FUNDER	STAGE	FOCUS	AREA	TIPS
Micro-traction	Pre-seed → Seed	Tech startups	Primarily Nigeria	Highlight early revenue, MVP, and founder capability; short, crisp pitch deck
GreenHouse Capital	Growth-stage	Fintech, payments, financial inclusion	Primarily Nigeria, open to cross-border fintech pilots	Focus on revenue growth, CAC, and scalable model
Ingressive Capital	Pre-seed → Seed	Tech startups	Pan-Africa; invests in multiple African countries	Demonstrate product-market fit and early traction; emphasize team experience
Bank linked SME fund Access Bank, GTBank	Seed → Growth	SMEs in Nigeria; any sector	Typically local only	Check eligibility for grants/credit lines; strong financials and business plan improve chances

Ghana

VC/ FUNDER	STAGE	FOCUS	AREA	TIPS
Ghana Angel Investor Network (GAIN)	Seed → Early	Tech startups, SMEs, diverse sectors	Primarily Ghana	Showcase strong founding team, traction, and early revenue
Injaro	Growth-stage	Agribusiness, agriculture tech	Regional (West Africa), Ghana-focused portfolio	Highlight impact on productivity and regional scalability; solid financial projections required
MEST Ventures	Pre-seed → Seed	Tech startups	Primarily Ghana, some Pan-African	Apply via MEST incubator; show product-market fit, early users, and team capability
Chale Fund	Seed → Early	Pan-African tech startups	Pan-Africa	Focus on scalability, unit economics, and cross-border expansion potential

Cameroon

VC/ FUNDER	STAGE	FOCUS	AREA	TIPS
AfricInvest	Growth-stage	SMEs, agri, fintech, industrials	Active across Francophone Africa	Highlight revenue traction, regional scalability, and strong governance; financial projections must be robust
Seedstars	Pre-seed → Seed	Early-stage tech startups	Pan-Africa, global early-stage programs	show product-market fit, traction, and potential to scale across Africa
Cameroon-focused DFIs / Impact Funds (IFC, AfDB country desks)	Growth-stage	SMEs, impact-driven ventures	Country-specific (Cameroon)	Focus on measurable development impact, financial sustainability, and alignment with DFI objectives; show potential for replication

South Africa

VC/ FUNDER	STAGE	FOCUS	AREA	TIPS
Knife Capital	Growth-stage	Tech-enabled scale-ups, innovation-driven SMEs	Select Pan-African deals	Show measurable growth and clear exit potential; emphasize traction and scalability beyond SA
Naspers Foundry	Growth → Later-stage	South African tech startups (platforms, digital, e-commerce)	Primarily South Africa	Must be incorporated in SA; highlight innovation, proven traction, and large addressable market
4Di Capital	Seed → Early	Tech startups (fintech, SaaS, healthtech)	Occasionally invests across Africa	Emphasize early traction, strong team, and scalable model; ideal for high-tech or software ventures

South Africa

VC/ FUNDER	STAGE	FOCUS	AREA	TIPS
HAVAÍC	Early → Growth	Tech startups, digital platforms	Pan-African and international	Show cross-border potential, defensible tech, and clear monetization model
Kalon Venture Partners	Growth → Later-stage	Tech-enabled scale-ups	Primarily South Africa	Highlight innovation and growth metrics; strong governance and financial reporting are key
Edge Growth / Grovest	Growth → Scale	SME growth, impact, and scale funding	Mostly South Africa	Present a clear plan for job creation and sustainable scaling; impact measurement strengthens applications

South Africa

VC/ FUNDER	STAGE	FOCUS	AREA	TIPS
Industrial Development Corporation (IDC)	Scale → Expansion	Manufacturing, industrial, and large-scale enterprises	Pan-African and international	Provide detailed financials and feasibility; strong business case required for development finance
Standard Bank / Absa Venture Funds / Corporate VC Arms	Seed → Growth	Fintech, enterprise solutions, scalable innovations	Regional presence across Africa	Approach via innovation hubs or bank partnerships; focus on alignment with financial inclusion or digital strategy

Kenya

VC/ FUNDER	STAGE	FOCUS	AREA	TIPS
Novastar Ventures	Early → Growth	Scalable businesses in essential sectors (agri, education, health, energy)	Pan-Africa (East & West Africa)	Emphasize measurable impact, solid governance, and growth in underserved markets; strong management team essential
Savannah Fund	Seed → Early	Tech startups, SaaS, mobile, fintech	Pan-Africa, with Kenya base	Focus on high-growth tech with early traction; include data-driven traction metrics and clear regional roadmap
iHub / Nailab Ecosystem	Pre-seed → Seed	Tech innovation, digital startups	Primarily Kenya, open to East Africa	Apply through accelerator or demo programs; focus on MVP validation, problem-solution clarity, and team strength

Kenya

VC/ FUNDER	STAGE	FOCUS	AREA	TIPS
Innovation Center (KCIC)	Seed → Growth	Climate, clean energy, agribusiness	Primarily Kenya	Highlight environmental and social impact; measurable sustainability outcomes are key
KCB Bank SME Programs	Growth → Scale	SMEs across sectors	Only Kenya	Demonstrate creditworthiness, strong financials, and potential for job creation; grants often tied to donor programs

Uganda

VC/ FUNDER	STAGE	FOCUS	AREA	TIPS
Goodwell Investments	Growth → Expansion	Inclusive finance, mobility, agri, and digital impact ventures	Pan-Africa (active in East & West Africa)	Highlight measurable impact and scalable, inclusive business models; show traction and sustainability metrics
Regional DFIs & Impact Funds (e.g., Acumen, EIB, FMO, AfDB)	Early → Growth	High-impact sectors — energy, health, agriculture, education	Pan-Africa, active in Uganda	Demonstrate clear social impact, financial viability, and measurable outcomes; partnerships strengthen proposals

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Practical Tips for Using This List

1. Narrow your outreach: Match your business stage & sector with the appropriate fund. Don't pitch seed metrics to a growth fund.
2. Warm intros: Ask existing portfolio founders or mutual contacts for introductions.
3. Local presence: Funds prefer local registration or at least local partners for legal and operational speed.
4. Tailor your ask: State the funding amount, use of funds, traction, and expected milestones with timelines.
5. Have documentation ready: Prepare a pitch deck, 12-month financials, cap table, customer references, and incorporation documents.

List of VCs

Nigeria

1. Lateral Capital
2. LoftyInc Capital Management
3. Verod Capital
4. Partech Africa
5. Leadpath Africa
6. Growth Capital by SMEDAN / Corporate SME Funds
7. Alitheia Capital
8. Kora Capital
9. Ventures Garden Group
10. Nigeria Sovereign Investment Authority (NSIA)
11. Capital Square Partners
12. Raba Capital
13. FCMB / FBN VC Programmes

Ghana

1. Blue Haven Initiative
2. BlueOrchard
3. O Capital Africa / Oasis Fund
4. Volta Capital Partners
5. RLG Capital
6. Investisseurs & Partenaires (I&P)
7. GIPC / Ghana Enterprise Agency Grants

List of VCs

Cameroon

1. VC4A
2. Proparco / AFD-backed SME Funds
3. Lion's Head Global Partners
4. Local Angel & Impact Funds

South Africa

1. RMB Ventures / Rand Merchant Bank Ventures
2. GroFin
3. Savant Group
4. Futuregrowth Asset Management
5. Newtown Partners
6. Hlayisani Capital
7. African Rainbow Capital (ARC Investments)
8. Old Mutual Alternative Investments
9. TIA / Technology Innovation Agency
10. FNB Innovation Hub

Kenya

1. KCB Ventures
2. KenInvest
3. BlueMark Capital
4. DOB Equity
5. GrowthAfrica
6. Africa50
7. 88mph
8. CRE Venture Capital

List of VCs

Uganda

1. Evolve Venture Partners
2. Start Something Uganda
3. Development Finance Institutions (KfW, IFC, AfDB)
4. Ugandan Accelerators with Investment Arms

Tanzania

1. Tanzania Development Finance Corporation (TDFCL)
2. GSMA Innovation Fund
3. Local VC & Angel Groups
4. African Development Bank (AfDB)
5. DOB Equity
6. Acumen Fund
7. Seedstars Tanzania

Zambia

1. Zambian Development Agency Funds
2. GroFin
3. Acumen Fund
4. IFC-led SME Growth Funds
5. KfW / FCDO Private Sector Programs
6. Local Angel & SME Funds

Calculate Key Growth Metrics

Understand what drives your growth and where to optimize before seeking funding.

CAC (Customer Acquisition Cost) – How much it costs to gain one new customer.

How to work it out

🧮 Formula: (Total Marketing + Sales Costs) ÷ New Customers

LTV (Customer Lifetime Value) – How much a customer spends with you over time.

How to work it out

🧮 Formula: Avg. Purchase × Frequency × Lifespan

Churn Rate – The percentage of customers you lose over a period.

How to work it out

🧮 Formula: (Customers Lost ÷ Customers at Start) × 100

Conversion Rate – The percentage of leads or visitors who become paying customers.

How to work it out

🧮 Formula: (Customers ÷ Leads) × 100

✅ Outcome: You'll know exactly what drives your growth, and what to improve before raising capital.

Cash Flow Drill
Review your last 6 months of cash inflows (money in) and outflows (money out).

Identify:

- Where you can cut costs or improve efficiency
- How to extend your runway by reducing burn or boosting revenue

Month	Inflows	Outflows	Net Cash Flow

Section 2: Build Your Story — The Pitch Deck Blueprint

🧭 **Objective:**
Create a pitch deck that clearly tells your business story and excites investors.

1.PROBLEM — WHAT'S BROKEN IN THE MARKET?



2.SOLUTION — WHAT'S YOUR UNIQUE APPROACH?

3.MARKET OPPORTUNITY — HOW BIG IS IT?



4.PRODUCT/SERVICE — DEMO OR KEY FEATURES.

5.TRACTION — KEY MILESTONES, REVENUE, USERS, PARTNERSHIPS.



6.BUSINESS MODEL — HOW YOU MAKE MONEY.

7.MARKET STRATEGY — HOW YOU ACQUIRE AND RETAIN CUSTOMERS.



8.COMPETITION — WHO ELSE IS IN THE SPACE, AND WHY YOU WIN.

9.TEAM — WHO'S BEHIND THE VISION.



10.FINANCIALS — 3-YEAR PROJECTIONS AND KEY METRICS.

11.ASK — HOW MUCH FUNDING YOU NEED AND WHAT IT'S FOR.



12. BE CLEAR AND CONCISE

Activities:

- **Compare your deck with 2 successful African startup decks.**
- **Highlight 3 weak or missing slides.**

✅ **Outcome: You'll have a complete, professional pitch that resonates with investors.**

Section 3: Pitch Like a Pro — The Confidence Builder

🧭 **Objective:**
Get comfortable speaking about your business with clarity and conviction.

Exercises:

Elevator Pitch Challenge:
- **Describe your business in 30 seconds.**
- **Record yourself and time it — refine until it's natural and engaging.**

The "Why Us" Question:
- **Write a 2-sentence answer to: "Why should an investor back you?**

Role-Play Investor Q&A:
- **Have a partner or friend ask these:**
  - **What problem are you solving?**
  - **How do you make money?**
  - **What makes your team the right one?**
  - **What's your biggest risk?**

✅ **Outcome: You'll be confident, clear, and ready for real investor conversations.**

Section 4: Strategic Readiness: Funding Isn't the Only Way

🧭 **Objective:**
Learn to grow sustainably while keeping funding optional.

Activities:

- Identify 3 non-funding growth levers (e.g. partnerships, revenue reinvestment, automation).
- Build a "Self-Funding Strategy" — outline how your business can grow from cash flow.

✅ **Outcome: You'll become stronger and more attractive to investors by being less dependent on them.**

Section 5: Mapping the Funding Landscape

🧭 **Objective:**
Understand who funds what — and how to align your business with the right opportunities.

Activities:

- **Research 5 funding bodies or grant programs relevant to your sector.**
- **Document for each:**
- **Name > Focus Area > Funding > Type > Website > Application Cycle**

✅ Outcome: You'll have your first mini "funding map" to build on later.

Next Step: Go Deeper with the P23 Africa Funding Directory
Once you've completed this guide, you'll be ready for the next level:

📘 The Funding & Investor Directory for African Entrepreneurs — a premium, data-packed guide that includes:

- 🌍 40+ country database of active investors in Africa
- 💰 100+ international grant funders supporting African startups
- 🤝 Direct contacts, investment focus areas, and application timelines
- 🧠 Bonus: Pitch templates and funding strategy planners

Get it when you're ready to start raising — and we'll help you prepare your investor documents through our Investor-Ready Services.

SECTION 1: VALIDATE YOUR BUSINESS IDEA

Objective:

Before any investor funds your idea, you must prove it's solving a real problem for a real audience.

Activity

Exercise 1: Problem Validation
Answer these questions:

1. **What problem does your product solve?**
2. **Who feels this problem most (your early adopters)?**
3. **How are they currently solving it (competitors or alternatives)?**
4. **Why is your solution better?**

✅ **Outcome: You'll identify your real target audience and the problem they'll pay to solve.**

Exercise 2: Proof of Interest
Use free tools or methods to show interest in your idea: Either

- **Create a landing page describing your solution and collect emails.**
- **Conduct 10 short interviews with potential users.**
- **Run a social poll or community post testing the problem statement.**

✅ **Outcome: You'll have early market validation data — something tangible to show investors.**

SECTION 2: GET FINANCIALLY CLEAR (EVEN BEFORE YOU START SELLING)

Objective:

Investors want to see that you understand the business side of your idea, how it can make money and how you plan to spend it.

Activity

Exercise 1: Map Your Revenue Model
Even if you haven't made sales yet, outline:

- **How you plan to make money (product sales, subscriptions, ads, etc.)**
- **How much you'll charge (estimated price or rate).**
- **What your costs will be (product creation, marketing, team).**

✅ **Outcome: You'll build a simple, clear financial model — a roadmap for future profitability.**

Exercise 2: Create a Lean Startup Budget
List only the essential expenses to test and launch your idea.
Use this simple framework:

Category	Item	Cost

Section 3: Build Your Story — The Pitch Deck Blueprint

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1.PROBLEM — WHAT'S BROKEN IN THE MARKET?



2.SOLUTION — WHAT'S YOUR UNIQUE APPROACH?

3.MARKET OPPORTUNITY — HOW BIG IS IT?



4.PRODUCT/SERVICE — DEMO OR KEY FEATURES.

5.TRACTION — KEY MILESTONES, REVENUE, USERS, PARTNERSHIPS.



6.BUSINESS MODEL — HOW YOU MAKE MONEY.

7.MARKET STRATEGY — HOW YOU ACQUIRE AND RETAIN CUSTOMERS.



8.COMPETITION — WHO ELSE IS IN THE SPACE, AND WHY YOU WIN.

9.TEAM — WHO'S BEHIND THE VISION.



10.FINANCIALS — 3-YEAR PROJECTIONS AND KEY METRICS.

11.ASK — HOW MUCH FUNDING YOU NEED AND WHAT IT'S FOR.



12. BE CLEAR AND CONCISE

Activities:

- **Compare your deck with 2 successful African startup decks.**
- **Highlight 3 weak or missing slides.**

✅ **Outcome: You'll have a complete, professional pitch that resonates with investors.**

Section 4: Pitch Like a Pro — The Confidence Builder

🧭 **Objective:**
Get comfortable speaking about your business with clarity and conviction.

Exercises:

Elevator Pitch Challenge:
- **Describe your business in 30 seconds.**
- **Record yourself and time it — refine until it's natural and engaging.**

The "Why Us" Question:
- **Write a 2-sentence answer to: "Why should an investor back you?**

Role-Play Investor Q&A:
- **Have a partner or friend ask these:**
  - **What problem are you solving?**
  - **How do you make money?**
  - **What makes your team the right one?**
  - **What's your biggest risk?**

✅ **Outcome: You'll be confident, clear, and ready for real investor conversations.**

Step 5: Funding Without Revenue
Even without traction, you can access non-dilutive funding (grants) or early-stage investment if you present a clear, validated idea.

Types of Funding You Can Access:
Grants & Competitions:
For early validation and proof of concept (e.g., local innovation hubs, startup accelerators).

Angel Investors:
Often back early ideas if they trust the founder and see a big market.

Friends & Family:
Small initial amounts to test your idea or build an MVP.

Crowdfunding:
Platforms like GoFundMe, Kickstarter, or local versions (for tech or social projects).

Partnerships:
Collaborate with existing businesses who benefit from your idea.

Exercise: Find Your First Funding Source

- **Identify 3 grants, competitions, or partners aligned with your sector.**
- **Research their eligibility and deadlines.**
- **Prepare a short summary (1-page) of your idea and impact.**

✅ **Outcome: You'll have 3 realistic funding targets — ready to pursue immediately.**

Next Step: Go Deeper with the P23 Africa Funding Directory
Once you've completed this guide, you'll be ready for the next level:

📘 The Funding & Investor Directory for African Entrepreneurs — a premium, data-packed guide that includes:

- 🌍 120-country database of active investors in Africa
- 💰 100+ international grant funders supporting African startups
- 🤝 Direct contacts, investment focus areas, and application timelines
- 🧠 Bonus: Pitch templates and funding strategy planners

Get it when you're ready to start raising — and we'll help you prepare your investor documents through our Investor-Ready Services.

